MALAYSIA

20 Authentic Local Crafts, Souvenirs & Specialties

A practical keepsake guide for travellers

Explore traditional textiles, handmade accessories, regional foods, artisan products, and cultural keepsakes that represent Malaysia’s diverse heritage. The descriptions below are based on the supplied list and retain its original recommendations.

01. Malaysian Batik (Textiles & Clothing)

Hand-drawn (batik lukis) or block-stamped (batik cap) fabrics featuring vibrant floral and geometric motifs; available as sarongs, scarves, shirts, and tote bags.

02. Royal Selangor Pewterware

High-grade tin-alloy items tied to Malaysia’s tin-mining heritage, including tankards, coasters, photo frames, tea caddies, and miniature Petronas Twin Towers.

03. Songket Fabric

Luxurious handwoven silk or cotton brocade intricately threaded with metallic gold or silver, traditionally worn for royal and ceremonial occasions.

04. Peranakan / Nyonya Beadwork (Kasut Manek)

Intricate, hand-stitched glass seed-bead slippers, pouches, and decorative accessories originating from Melaka and Penang.

05. Peranakan Tiles & Porcelain

Colorful, pastel-toned encaustic floor tiles (great as coasters or framed wall art) and floral kamcheng ceramic jars.

06. Sarawak Black & White Pepper

World-renowned, aromatic peppercorns grown in Borneo, sold in lightweight vacuum-sealed packs.

07. Ipoh White Coffee

Roasted with palm-oil margarine for a rich, caramelized flavor; sold in convenient, lightweight instant sachet packs.

08. BOH Cameron Highlands Tea

Loose-leaf black teas and flavored blends grown in Malaysia’s cool mountain estates.

09. Sarawak Pua Kumbu Textiles

Traditional ceremonial ikat-dyed cotton cloths woven by the Iban people of Borneo, featuring bold tribal and nature motifs.

10. Rattan & Pandan Woven Crafts

Hand-plaited baskets, bags, floor mats, and hats crafted by indigenous Orang Asli and Sabah/Sarawak artisans.

11. Sabah Cultured Pearls

Freshwater and sea pearl necklaces, earrings, and bracelets sold at great value in Kota Kinabalu markets.

12. Wau Bulan (Traditional Moon Kite)

Miniature decorative versions of Kelantan's iconic crescent-shaped, intricately patterned traditional kite.

13. Kelantanese Silver Filigree Jewelry

Fine, handcrafted silver brooches (kerongsang), bangles, and pendants featuring traditional Malay floral patterns.

14. Sarawak Kek Lapis (Layered Cake)

Vibrant, geometric, multi-layered spiced butter cakes sold in neat, travel-friendly boxed loaves.

15. Dodol & Kuih Kapit (Traditional Sweets)

Chewy coconut-and-palm-sugar toffee (dodol, often flavored with durian or pandan) and crisp folded coconut wafer biscuits (love letters).

16. Borneo Beadwork (Pinakol)

Colorful geometric beaded necklaces, belts, and wristbands handmade by the Rungus community in Sabah.

17. Traditional Woodcarvings (Ukiran Kayu)

Hand-carved tropical hardwood wall panels, trays, and decorative boxes featuring Islamic geometric and floral designs.

18. Beryl's & Local Artisan Chocolates

Famous Malaysian-made chocolates, especially durian-filled, tiramisu, and single-origin Malaysian cacao bars.

19. Penang Nutmeg Balms & Oils

Traditional medicinal ointments, massage oils, and preserved nutmeg snacks produced on Penang Island.

20. Congkak Board Game

A traditional wooden mancala-style counting game carved into a boat-shaped board, doubling as an authentic cultural decor piece.

Traveller note: Before purchasing food, liquids, plant-based products, pearls, or wooden items, check the airline's baggage rules and the destination country's customs and import restrictions. For handmade or culturally significant items, ask the seller about the maker, materials, and place of origin.